

BACKGROUND PAPER

Historical Security Council 1

HSC 1 · Room 508

TOPIC 1

The Congo Crisis: ONUC Involvement in National Conflicts, 1962

TOPIC 2

The Cuban Missile Crisis: Preventing Nuclear War, 1962

The Security Council as it stood in 1962. On the Congo: following independence from Belgium in 1960, the breakdown of civil order displaced tens of thousands, and the UN deployed its largest peacekeeping force at the time (ONUC), raising the question of where foreign intervention ends and national sovereignty begins. On Cuba: the United States has discovered Soviet nuclear missiles ninety miles from its mainland, and the Council has days, not weeks.

Full background paper coming soon.

The Secretariat will publish the complete guide — including the history of the question, bloc positions and questions a resolution must answer — before the conference. Delegates should begin their own research in the meantime.